THE VERSION I WAS

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FADE IN: INT. LITTLE GIRL'S BEDROOM - LATE AFTERNOON

WARM SUNLIGHT SPILLS THROUGH THE WINDOW. A SMALL, SLIGHTLY MESSY BEDROOM. DRAWINGS TAPED UNEVENLY TO THE WALL. STUFFED ANIMALS ON THE BED. A PILE OF MARKERS ON THE FLOOR.

The Young Girl (8) lies on her stomach, drawing. She hums to herself. A quiet creak from the hallway. Another sound a light knock against wood. She lifts her head. The doorway is open. Someone stands there.

OLDER SELF (17) half in shadow, half in light. She doesn't step inside. They look at each other. No fear. Just curiosity.

THE GIRL
Are you my babysitter?

OLDER SELF
No

THE GIRL
Do I know you?

OLDER SELF
Not yet.

THE YOUNG GIRL
Then why are you in my house?

OLDER SELF
I used to live here.

THE GIRL
Okay. So who are you

OLDER SELF
I'm you

THE GIRL
Woah, so like we can time travel?

OLDER SELF
Something like that, its complicated

She goes back to drawing. Older Self watches her, emotional, restrained.

OLDER SELF
What are you making?

THE GIRL
A butterfly, it’s not done yet.

INT. LITTLE GIRL’S BEDROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Older Self steps fully into the room for the first time. She moves carefully, like the space might disappear. She notices: A crooked drawing, A chipped dresser handle, A stuffed bear missing an eye.

OLDER SELF
You still keep everything make you know

THE GIRL
I might need it.

OLDER SELF
You won’t I promise

THE GIRL
That’s rude.

Older Self smiles.

OLDER SELF
You’re right. Sorry.

THE GIRL
So you're me?

OLDER SELF
You in the future

THE GIRL
How old are you?

OLDER SELF
17.

THE GIRL
Wow that's big

THE GIRL
Do I still live here when I’m big?

OLDER SELF
Yes but you change a few things around

Older Self gestures around the room.

THE GIRL
I still like it.

The girl looks around, unconvinced.

OLDER SELF
I know.

OLDER SELF
Let me tell you something, don't rush growing up.

THE GIRL
I'm not.

OLDER SELF (JOKINGLY)
What did you ask Mom for this morning?

THE GIRL
A phone.

OLDER SELF
See? You kind of are.

THE GIRL
Everyone has one though.

OLDER SELF
I know. I said the same thing.

OLDER SELF
I was very dramatic about it too.

THE GIRL
Did it work?

OLDER SELF
Yeah. I was very convincing.

THE GIRL
So… phones are good then?

Older Self thinks, choosing her words carefully.

OLDER SELF
They're not bad. But they stop you from things

THE GIRL
Like what?

OLDER SELF
Talking.

THE GIRL
You can talk on phones.

Older Self smiles, she was expecting that.

OLDER SELF
Yeah. But I mean talking like this. People start using their phones instead of talking to each other

THE GIRL
Why?

OLDER SELF
Because it’s easier to look down than to look at someone.

THE GIRL
Do people still talk to me?

OLDER SELF
They do. Just… less.

THE GIRL
That’s sad.

OLDER SELF
A little

THE GIRL
So I should talk more?

OLDER SELF
Yeah. But also listen more.

The girl nods, very seriously.

THE GIRL
Okay. I’m good at that.

THE GIRL
Do I forget this room?

OLDER SELF
No. You changed it quite a bit once you got to middle school, then changed it again in high school

THE GIRL
So do we still want to be a princess when we grow up?

OLDER SELF
No. Hahaha

THE GIRL
Dolphin trainer?

OLDER SELF
What? No definitely not.

THE GIRL
So what do we want to be ?

OLDER SELF
We still don't know yet but we love filmmaking and working with cameras.

THE GIRL
Oh that's cool so like what do we do

OLDER SELF
We make our movies with our best friends.

THE GIRL
Are we still friends with Mia?

OLDER SELF
Of course! She's our best friend We're making a film together!

THE GIRL
What's a film?

OLDER SELF
A movie
(Laughs)

THE GIRL
So we work in Hollywood? Do we get to walk down a red carpet?

OLDER SELF
Not yet, getting there though. One day.

THE GIRL
Do we marry Justin Bieber?

OLDER SELF
Oh my gosh, no! Im 17 and he's married to someone else now and I have a boyfriend

THE GIRL
Aw man are you sure?

OLDER SELF
About Justin Bieber being married or me having a boyfriend?

YOUNGER SELF
You marrying Justin Bieber

OLDER SELF
Oh yes I'm sure

THE GIRL
Do I stop drawing?

OLDER SELF
You stop drawing like this.

She gestures to the floor

OLDER SELF
But you still have ideas. They just get quieter.

THE GIRL
I don’t want them to be quiet.

OLDER SELF
Then don’t rush.

THE GIRL
Can I still get a phone?

OLDER SELF
Yeah. You know… someday you’ll think about this room.

THE GIRL
Think about it how?

OLDER SELF
Like it was bigger than it seemed. Like every little thing mattered more than we knew.

THE GIRL
But I don’t want to forget it.

OLDER SELF
You won’t. Even if you think you might.

THE GIRL
Promise?

OLDER SELF
Promise! But as hard as it will be remember you don't need to follow what everyone is doing, make your own path and do what you want and what makes you happy,its your life not anyone else's. Don't let anyone tell you what you can and can't do.

THE GIRL
Ok I won't

The girl nods, very seriously.

OLDER SELF
Oh and don't even try to date Jeremy he's not worth your time.

THE GIRL
Whose Jeremy?

OLDER SELF
This guy you will meet in 8th grade, do yourself a favor and stay far away from him

THE GIRL
Okay got it.

A voice calls from down the hall.

MOM (O.S.)
Dinner!

THE GIRL
That’s me.

She hops up.

THE GIRL
Are you gonna eat with us?

Older Self shakes her head gently.

OLDER SELF
I don’t think this part’s for me.

THE GIRL
Why?

OLDER SELF
Because it’s yours.

THE GIRL
You can stay anyways I don't mind

OLDER SELF
I shouldn’t. I have prom tonight

THE GIRL
Wow prom, thats so cool, whats prom?

OLDER SELF
Its a school dance

THE GIRL
Wow what are you gonna wear,you can wear this dress

OLDER SELF
Oh well I'm not sure I will fit in that, it might be a bit snug

THE GIRL
You could try it on

OLDER SELF
That's ok, I am wearing a purple dress

MOM (O.S.)
Dinner!

OLDER SELF
Girl you gotta go, you know she isn't gonna reheat your dinner

THE GIRL
That's what she always says, Can you come back later

OLDER SELF
Of course

THE GIRL
Bye.

They hug each other

She runs out of the room. The doorway is empty again. Older Self stands alone. She looks around one last time. Touches the wall lightly.

INT. OLDER GIRL'S ROOM - MID DAY

The room is quiet. Not dramatic. Just late. OLDER SELF sits on the floor, back against the bed. Phone on the carpet beside her. Screen dark. She rubs her eyes. A knock.

OLDER SELF
Yeah?

The door opens.

YOUNGER SELF stands there, holding onto the doorframe. She looks around like she's checking if she's allowed to be here.

YOUNGER SELF
Mom said I could come in.

OLDER SELF blinks.

OLDER SELF
Mom's asleep.

YOUNGER SELF
Then I guess I'm sneaking in!

She steps in anyway. OLDER SELF sighs, lets it go. YOUNGER SELF climbs onto the bed, curls up with a pillow. Watches her.

YOUNGER SELF
Why are you on the floor?

OLDER SELF
I didn't feel like sitting up.

YOUNGER SELF
That usually means something bad happened.

OLDER SELF
Yeah.

YOUNGER SELF
Did you get grounded?

OLDER SELF
No.

YOUNGER SELF
Did you fail a test?

OLDER SELF
No.

A pause. The kid thinks harder.

YOUNGER SELF
Did someone yell at you?

OLDER SELF
Not really.

YOUNGER SELF
Then why are you crying like that?

OLDER SELF looks away.

OLDER SELF
My boyfriend and I broke up.

YOUNGER SELF frowns.

YOUNGER SELF
Like… the phone kind of broke?
Or like the arm kind of broke?

OLDER SELF
Neither.

YOUNGER SELF
Can you fix it?

OLDER SELF
No.

YOUNGER SELF
Did you try saying sorry?

OLDER SELF
It’s not really like that.

YOUNGER SELF
Then what happened?

OLDER SELF searches for words.

OLDER SELF
He doesn’t love me anymore.

YOUNGER SELF processes this slowly.

YOUNGER SELF
So… you’re not allowed to hang out?

OLDER SELF
I guess.

YOUNGER SELF
Forever?

OLDER SELF
Probably.

YOUNGER SELF
That seems unfair.

OLDER SELF
Yeah.

YOUNGER SELF
Did you do something mean?

OLDER SELF
No.

YOUNGER SELF
Did he?

OLDER SELF
No. That’s kind of the worst part.

YOUNGER SELF hugs the pillow tighter.

YOUNGER SELF
So no one’s in trouble?

OLDER SELF
No one’s in trouble.

YOUNGER SELF
Oh is that your dress you were telling me about

OLDER SELF
Yes, what do you think

YOUNGER SELF (SASSY)
I think you look very pretty

OLDER SELF
Thank you
(Laughs)

YOUNGER SELF
So how was prom

Older self look at her very confused

YOUNGER SELF
I meant before you got broken up with

OLDER SELF
Oh it was magical, I had a date for the first time, my dream dress, and my dream shoes up until Dylan broke up with me and we didn't even get to do a slow dance

YOUNGER SELF
Well on the bright side you still have your dress and shoes and who needs a boy anyways, boys have cooties.

OLDER SELF (STARTING TO STAND UP)
I guess you're right

YOUNGER SELF
And we can slow dance now

OLDER SELF
Here

Older self give the younger self her shoes and bracelet and finds a old crown in her closet turns on slow music on her phone and they start to playfully dance around her room, the music fades off.

Younger self starts to walk around and look at her room

YOUNGER SELF
Where are all of our drawings?

OLDER SELF
In a drawer

YOUNGER SELF
Can I see them

Older self gets up and takes a stack of drawing out of a drawer and gives them to her younger self.

YOUNGER SELF
Why arn't they hanging up? Your room is so boring

OLDER SELF
Yea? How so?

YOUNGER SELF
Theres like no pink, no crayons or markers, not even a princess. What happened to our room

OLDER SELF
We grew up

The younger self gets up and sits at the makeup chair and starts to open all the drawers

YOUNGER SELF
Wow we sure have a lot of makeup

OLDER SELF
Yea we do

The older self starts to take the pictures of her and her ex off the wall and out of the frame and starts to cry again. While the younger version starts to put lipstick all over her mouth. The older self looks up with tears in her eyes and sees the younger self playing with the makeup.

OLDER SELF
Oh gosh, slow down.

Older self starts laughing, and starts to wiping the makeup off her face. The younger version sits down next to the older version

YOUNGER SELF
Don't cry, you can find someone different you know

OLDER SELF
I guess so

YOUNGER SELF sits beside her on the floor. Their shoulders touch. The younger self still has on her shoes and her crown and bracelet